



GOVERNMENT OF
KARNATAKA
DEPT. OF E, IT, BI AND SAT

MANGALURU CLUSTER

Vision Document 2025



Karnataka Digital
Economy Mission

WELCOME TO SILICON BEACH OF INDIA

A Strategic Roadmap to Accelerate Inclusive:



DIGITAL INNOVATION



INVESTMENT



INDUSTRY GROWTH

K-tech



STARTUP
KARNATAKA

BEYOND
BANGALURU

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Mangaluru is on the brink of a transformative journey, emerging as a vibrant hub for innovation, technology, and entrepreneurship in coastal Karnataka. With its strategic location, thriving academic landscape, and industrial talent pool, Mangaluru holds the promise of becoming a global destination for digital excellence.

At KDEM, we are proud to present the Draft Mangaluru Cluster Vision Report, a comprehensive roadmap to unlock the region's potential in IT/ITES, fintech, healthcare, and logistics. Anchored by a network of 25+ engineering institutions, incubators, and a rapidly growing start-up ecosystem, Mangaluru cluster is poised to lead the next wave of digital growth Beyond Bengaluru.

This vision is backed by strategic priorities—nurturing Global Capability Centres (GCCs), establishing Centers of Excellence, and enabling a robust entrepreneurial ecosystem. Our goal is ambitious yet achievable: catalysing the creation of 4,000+ startups and over 2 lakh new jobs by 2034, while fostering innovation that is inclusive, sustainable, and globally competitive.

With a strong focus on skilling, infrastructure, and industry-academia collaboration, we are laying the foundation for Mangaluru region's evolution into India's Silicon Beach. KDEM remains deeply committed to facilitating this growth through policy enablement, ecosystem partnerships,

and targeted investments.

We invite industry leaders, investors, entrepreneurs, and change-makers to join us in shaping Mangaluru's rise as a premier digital and innovation destination. Together, let us drive this vision forward and unlock a future of infinite possibilities.



Mr. BV Naidu

Chairman, KDEM

Mangaluru represents a powerful convergence of heritage, talent, and innovation, positioning it as a key pillar in Karnataka's digital growth journey. With the Beyond Bengaluru initiative, we aim to unlock the cluster's vast potential and drive the next wave of inclusive, innovation-led development.

The Government of Karnataka is committed to expanding the reach of the digital economy beyond metropolitan centers, and Mangaluru is poised to play a pivotal role in this transformation. With ₹4,500 crore in annual tech output including exports, over 225+ IT companies, and a thriving academic ecosystem, Mangaluru is already a vibrant hub for entrepreneurship, research, and emerging technologies.

This draft vision document presents a comprehensive roadmap to strengthen Mangaluru's position in sectors such as fintech, IT/ITES, clean energy, and logistics, while enabling the growth of start-ups, Global Capability Centres (GCCs), and Centers of Excellence (CoEs). Our focus is on building future-ready infrastructure, nurturing skilled talent, and promoting strategic investments to ensure sustainable and competitive growth.

We envision Mangaluru achieving ₹40,000 crore in tech exports, generating over 2 lakh jobs, and fostering 4,000+ startups by 2034. This ambitious target reflects our shared commitment to equitable regional development and innovation-driven progress.

We look forward to continued collaboration with industry leaders, academic institutions, and all stakeholders as we work together to shape Mangaluru into a globally recognized technology and innovation destination.



Dr. Ekroop Caur, IAS

Co-Chairperson, KDEM - Secretary to Government, Department of Electronics, Information Technology, Biotechnology and Science & Technology, Government of Karnataka

The Mangaluru cluster is emerging as a vibrant epicenter of technological innovation, entrepreneurship, and strategic investment. With its unique coastal advantage, strong academic ecosystem, and growing IT presence, the region is well-positioned to lead Karnataka's next wave of region-focused digital growth.

At KDEM, we are deeply committed to building a resilient and future-ready ecosystem in Mangaluru. This Draft Vision Report presents a comprehensive strategy to harness the region's strengths in fintech, IT/ITES, logistics, and clean energy while advancing innovation through Global Capability

Centres (GCCs), start-ups, and Centers of Excellence (CoEs).

We are working in close partnership with industry leaders, industry bodies, academic institutions, and Government to attract investments, develop infrastructure, and nurture skilled talent. The goal is to transform Mangaluru cluster into a globally competitive technology hub that delivers inclusive, sustainable, and high-impact growth.

As we chart this ambitious journey forward, the time is right for unified action. We welcome entrepreneurs, investors, academic institutions, and ecosystem enablers to come

together and co-create Mangaluru's future, a future defined by innovation, collaboration, and lasting impact.



Sanjeev Kumar Gupta

CEO, KDEM

It is a matter of great pride for the Karnataka Innovation and Technology Society (KITS) to be part of the creation of the Draft Mangaluru Cluster Vision Document 2025. The document is a testament to the state's commitment to building a truly inclusive, future-ready digital economy that extends beyond its metropolitan core.

Mangaluru's rich legacy of education, industry, and entrepreneurship forms a solid foundation for its ongoing emergence as a digital and innovation hub of national importance. The region's strong academic ecosystem, vibrant start-up culture, and expanding industrial presence present remarkable opportunities for collaborative growth.

As the implementation agency, KITS is dedicated to enabling the strategic priorities set forth in this Vision—expanding infrastructure, fostering industry-academia partnerships, supporting new-age skill development, and ensuring policy enablement for startups and global players alike. We recognize the need for agility and innovation in our approaches, and we are committed to nurturing an ecosystem where every aspiring entrepreneur, student, and enterprise finds the tools and support to scale new heights.

This vision document, shaped through consultations with industry anchors, government agencies, academia, and community partners, is a blueprint for action. It provides clear targets, actionable strategies, and a

collective commitment to transform Mangaluru into a destination for global investment, high-quality jobs, and sustainable development.

I convey my sincere appreciation to all stakeholders for their insights and collaboration. Together, let us work to translate this vision into measurable outcomes, ensuring that Mangaluru and Karnataka remain at the forefront of the digital transformation sweeping India.



Shri Rahul Sharanappa Sankanur, IAS

Board Member, KDEM | Director, Department of E, IT and Bt, Government of Karnataka
Managing Director, KITS

It gives me immense pride to witness Mangaluru's extraordinary journey from a vibrant port city with a rich cultural legacy to its current emergence as a global innovation hub—the "Silicon Beach of India." As an industry anchor closely involved in this transformation, I see first-hand how the convergence of talent, vision, and determination is setting a new benchmark for regional growth and impact.

Mangaluru's progress is the result of decades of relentless effort: by homegrown entrepreneurs, global corporations who placed their trust here, visionary educators, and forward-thinking policymakers. The ecosystem we are building today is underpinned by robust academic institutions, a thriving start-up and

tech culture, and the unwavering commitment of industry partners who have made this city their own.

This Draft Vision Document is more than a roadmap—it represents the collective voice and aspiration of industry, innovators, government, academia, and the wider community. Its targets—4,000+ startups by 2034, 2 lakh new digital jobs, and a global leadership role in technology services and product innovation—are ambitious, but deeply rooted in what we know is possible for Mangaluru.

The next decade is critical. We must accelerate infrastructure development, plug seamlessly into global value chains, and champion the power of talent and innovation emerging from our

colleges and startups. Equally, we must focus on inclusivity—ensuring benefits reach every participant, from early-career entrepreneurs to established enterprises and every citizen who stands to gain from a tech-driven economy.

As an entrepreneur who has built businesses in this land, I am personally invested in seeing Mangaluru become a beacon for bold ideas, dynamic partnerships, and sustainable prosperity. I urge current and future leaders—across industry, government, education, and civil society—to join in advancing this shared vision.

Let's make "Silicon Beach of India" not just a tagline but a lived reality for our region, our youth, and our nation.



Mr Rohith Bhat

Lead Industry Anchor, KDEM Mangaluru Cluster

Founder, wrkwrk/99Games/Robosoft

CLUSTER ECOSYSTEM PARTNERS IN PROGRAMS



Assocham



IESA



Nasscom



CII



Credai



Startupindia



KCCI



SHINE



CEOL



TIE-Bangalore



MANGALURU INDUSTRY ANCHORS



Rohith Bhat

Founder -
Wrkwrk/99Games/Robosoft



Praveen Kalbhavi

Co-founder & CEO -
Novigo



Prashanth Shenoy

Co-founder & CTO -
Unicourt



Gaurav Hegde

Managing Director
G R Stone Specialities Pvt Ltd



Johnson Tellis

CEO -
InUnity LLP



Ashith Hegde

Managing Director & CEO -
Asia, Ark



Murali Manohar

Regional Leader -
Rockwell Automation



Vijay Krishna

CEO -
Thought



Mohammed Hanif

CTO & Co Founder -
Novigo



Shylaja Rao

General Partner -
Ventana Partner



Mukesh S

AVP - Projects
Silicon Beach Program

KDEM TEAM



Sanjeev Kumar Gupta
CEO



Ajay Krishnan
Vice President - ESDM



Chetan Dixit
Vice President -
Beyond Bengaluru



Subha Mahata
Vice President - TA



Samir Venugopal
Vice President - IT GCCs



Bharath Chandra B K
Associate Vice President -
Startups & Innovation



Suvin P N
Lead and Project Manager -
Beyond Bengaluru



Gaurav K Punjabi
GM, Events & Marketing



Kumar S
Senior Manager - HR



Vakya Acamma MP
Associate - S&I



Varun M
Associate - IT GCCs



Samartha Shastri
Intern - BB



KARNATAKA DIGITAL ECONOMY MISSION (KDEM)

The Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM) is a Section 8 organization established to act as a knowledge bridge between the Government of Karnataka and the industry ecosystem, aiming to accelerate the growth of the state's IT, BT, and S&T sectors. With a goal of contributing **US\$300 billion** to the prime minister's vision of a **US\$1 trillion** digital economy, KDEM plays a vital role in supporting technology investments, identifying technology opportunities through research, coordinating promotional efforts abroad, providing policy feedback, and developing strategic roadmaps.

Core objectives by each KDEM vertical:

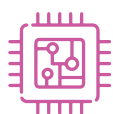


IT-ITES, BPM & GCC

Attract new-age global companies in IT & BPM, ER&D, and software products

Establish Karnataka as the most favored destination for Engineering and R&D

Support domestic and international outreach and partnership development



ESDM

Support the Investment Promotion Program for ESDM design centers

Facilitate the implementation of the ESDM Policy

Develop a plan to establish a "Semiconductor Technology Park"



Start-up & Innovation

Support the facilitation of the Start-up Policy

Support the innovation framework through CoEs, Business Incubators, and Instrumentation Facilities

Support ELEVATE companies through mentoring and acceleration programs



Talent Acceleration

Accelerate and transform Karnataka into a global hub for tech talent

Develop academic-industry partnerships to boost R&D

Create industry-ready skill programs at various levels

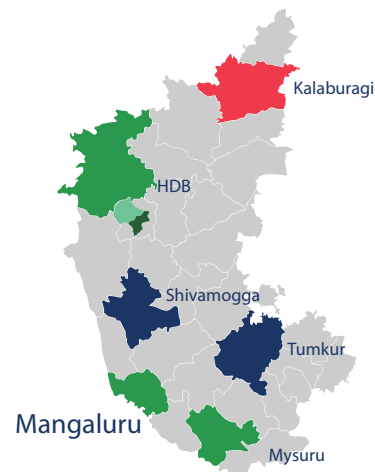


Beyond Bengaluru

The **Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM)**, a Section 8 organization, acts as a strategic bridge between the Government of Karnataka and industry stakeholders to accelerate the growth of the digital economy in the state. With a vision to contribute to the Hon'ble Prime Minister's \$1 trillion digital economy target, KDEM aims to drive Karnataka's contribution to \$300 billion. One of its flagship initiatives, the **Beyond Bengaluru Mission**, focuses on achieving inclusive and distributed growth by fostering IT/ITES, ESDM, startups, and innovation across tier-2 and tier-3 cities through six tech clusters: Mysuru, Mangaluru, Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi, Tumakuru, Kalaburagi, and Shivamogga.

Design Principles of Beyond Bengaluru Mission

- Even growth story all across the state
- Karnataka showcasing the model of each district growth
- Formation of clusters to cover all districts in the state
- State divided into 6 clusters



This mission supports regional growth through strategic initiatives such as **cluster-specific product specifications, industry-led ownership, and the spoke-shore strategy**. Key programs include **ELEVATE100, Cluster Seed Fund (CSF), Beyond Bengaluru BLUE, Karnataka Acceleration Network (KAN), and Entrepreneurship Development Programs (EDP)** in regions like Kalyana Karnataka. Dedicated offices have been launched in Mysuru, Mangaluru, and Hubballi to anchor growth.

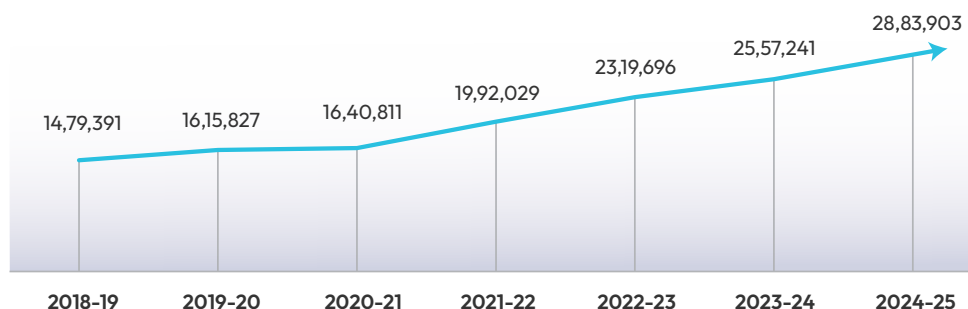
The draft vision document outlines the essential strategies needed to accelerate the 'Beyond Bengaluru program' in the Mangaluru cluster. These core strategies include:

- **Infrastructure Development:** Enhancing physical and digital infrastructure to support business operations and attract investments in the cluster.
- **Talent Development:** Implementing specialised training and educational programmes to increase the availability of skilled professionals in emerging technologies, tailored to the needs of the cluster.
- **Investment Promotion:** Creating targeted investment promotion programs to attract national and international businesses to the Mangaluru cluster, emphasizing the benefits of setting up operations beyond Bengaluru.
- **Support for Startups:** Providing comprehensive support for start-ups through incubators, accelerators, and funding opportunities, enabling a vibrant entrepreneurial ecosystem in the Mangaluru cluster.
- **Policy Facilitation:** Streamlining regulatory processes and offering policy support to ease the establishment and growth of businesses in the Mangaluru region.
- **Marketing and Outreach:** Conducting targeted marketing and outreach efforts to raise awareness about the opportunities and advantages of investing in the Mangaluru cluster.
- **Sustainable Development:** Ensuring that economic growth in the Mangaluru cluster is sustainable and inclusive, focusing on long-term benefits for the community and environment.

THE DIGITAL ECONOMIC STATUS OF KARNATAKA

Economic Overview – Karnataka

GDP of Karnataka (Rs. Crore)



Source: Karnataka Economic Survey, 2024-25



Economic Growth

GSDP: ₹25.57L Cr (2023-24) → ₹28.83L Cr (2024-25); 12.8% growth at current prices, 7.4% at constant prices.

Per Capita Income: 3,39,813 → 3,80,906 (12.1% growth); 90% higher than national average.

Developmental Expenditure: ₹2.08L Cr → ₹2.41L Cr (+15.83%).



Exports

Total Exports: ₹13.78L Cr (2023-24); 20.5% of India's exports.

Merchandise: 6.09%
Software/Services: 41%
Electronics & Software: One-third of India's Share



Industry & Services Sector

Industrial GSDP: ₹4.85L Cr → ₹5.29L Cr (9.2% growth); contributes 20.15% to state GSDP.

Sector Growth (2024-25):
• Industry: 5.8%
• Manufacturing: 6.4%
• IT Services share: 11.1% in services GSDP
• Services: 8.9%
• Construction: 3.5%



Urban Infrastructure

Tranche-1 (Davanagere, Harihara, etc.): ₹1,060.1 Cr spent of ₹1,238 Cr

Tranche-2 (Mangaluru, Udupi, etc.): ₹931.5 Cr spent of ₹1,345.18 Cr

IT & ITES Sector

- 536 companies registered under IT/ITES
- Power tariff concession to 288
- Stamp duty exemption to 38
- 20.37 lakh in rental reimbursements
- 3 projects approved (Apr 2023-Jan 2024): 596.1 Cr investment, 2,894 jobs

Start-up Ecosystem

- Multiple startup-focused funds launched
- Focus sectors: IT, biotech, healthcare, clean energy, agriculture
- Goal: 25,000 direct startup jobs
- Push for academia-industry-startup collaboration

ESDM Sector

- 76 companies registered under KESDM
- ₹18.98 Cr total incentives disbursed (₹1.18 Cr in 2023-24; ₹1.76 Cr in 2024-25)
- State aims to strengthen electronics and manufacturing leadership

ABOUT MANGALURU CLUSTER



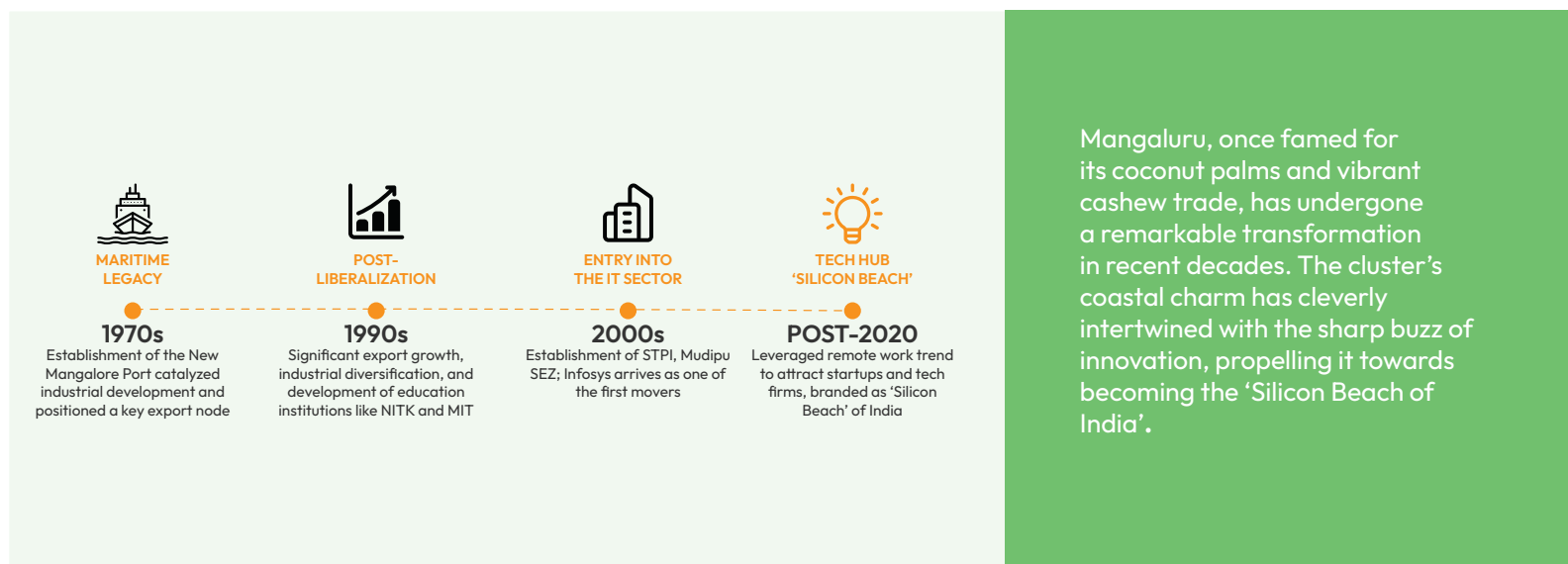
Parameter	Mangaluru
Cluster details	Mangaluru cluster consists of Dakshina Kannada, Udupi, Uttara Kannada and Kodagu .
Cluster highlights	1 st Startup district of India (as recognized by GoI) Home to the first government-established incubator for startups
Demographic details	- Population of around 5.425 Million - Adult literacy – 87% - Languages spoken include Kannada, Tulu, English, Hindi, Konkani - Ranks 4/37 in EODB in Deloitte's emerging tech hubs
No. of tech and tech-enabled startups	225+ technology companies Over INR 4500 cr output including exports from these companies every year
No. of GCCs	~5
Major industries	Mining, Refining, Agricultural Products; Rapid growth for BPOs/ Outsourcing, Fishing
SEZ	3
Fresh graduates in the cluster per year	40,000+
Engineering graduates	15,000+
Talent pool in tech companies	25,000+
No. of colleges	175+ Graduate colleges 25+ Engineering colleges
No. Of incubators	15+ incubation centers
STPI	1
Avg. salary of a software developer (5–8 yrs exp)	INR 8L–20 lakh per annum
Plug & Play Infra	3,35,000 sq. ft.
Co-working spaces	~500+
Office rental (Grade A office space)	INR 50–80/sq.ft./month
Upcoming facilities	Approx 10,00,000 sq. ft. under construction (5 IT Parks)
Cost of living index	19.12 (Good)
Crime index	25.07 (Good)
Pollution index	46.25 (Moderate)
Safe city index	Mangaluru ranks 49th globally out of 393 cities and Safety Index Score: 74.2

Gross/ Net District Domestic Product and Per Capita Net District Income for the year 2023-24(Provisional) (Rs. crore)

District	Gross Domestic Product		Net District Domestic Product (NDDP)		Per Capita NDDP at Current Prices
	Current Prices	Constant Prices	Current Prices	Constant Prices	
Dakshina Kannada	1,37,746	84,762	1,24,377	7,610	5,56,059
Udupi	67,503	40,675	61,266	36,616	5,33,469
Uttara Kannada	44,127	24,818	38,726	21,426	2,66,619
Kodagu	18,134	10,847	15,870	9,295	2,94,272
Mangaluru cluster	2,67,510	1,61,201	2,40,239	67,337	~ 4,54,491

Source: Karnataka Economic Survey 2024-25

HISTORY OF MANGALURU CLUSTER



Mangaluru, once famed for its coconut palms and vibrant cashew trade, has undergone a remarkable transformation in recent decades. The cluster's coastal charm has cleverly intertwined with the sharp buzz of innovation, propelling it towards becoming the 'Silicon Beach of India'.

In the 1960s, the establishment and rapid growth of premier technical institutes like the National Institute of Technology Karnataka (NITK), Surathkal, and Manipal Institute of Technology (MIT), Mangaluru, laid the foundation for a skilled engineering talent pool in the region. These institutes pioneered advanced engineering and technology programs, contributing significantly to Karnataka's technical development and industrial landscape.

Serving as catalysts for regional growth, MIT and NITK fostered strong industry-academia collaborations that spurred innovation, knowledge transfer, and entrepreneurship, attracting businesses to the area. Graduates from these institutions played key roles in government projects, public sector undertakings, and later, in the burgeoning IT and manufacturing sectors of Karnataka. Throughout the decade, these institutes established state-of-the-art laboratories and research facilities, positioning the region as an emerging hub of technical expertise. This robust educational foundation seeded the talent and innovation ecosystem that would, over the ensuing decades, drive the remarkable growth of Mangaluru's technology sector.

1970s–1980s: Industrial and Educational Expansion

During this period, Mangaluru witnessed the establishment and expansion of several industrial units, including petrochemical and fertilizer plants like MRPL (Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited). This bolstered the region's industrial base and created significant employment opportunities. Simultaneously, educational institutions expanded their capabilities, producing a steady supply of engineering and science graduates.

1990s: Liberalization and the Seeds of IT Growth

The economic liberalization of India in the early 1990s triggered significant private sector and foreign investments nationwide, including in Karnataka. Mangaluru began seeing IT and BPO companies setting up operations, leveraging its talent pool and cost advantages. During this decade, companies like Robosoft Technologies were founded, marking the start of a burgeoning local tech ecosystem.

Early 2000s: Foundation of a Startup and Innovation Ecosystem

The early 2000s brought greater recognition to Mangaluru as an emerging IT hub, backed by the establishment of technology parks, incubators, and skill development centers. The government introduced targeted incentives and infrastructure projects that supported startup growth and attracted satellite offices from leading IT/ITES companies.

2010s: Ecosystem Consolidation and Global Connectivity

Throughout the 2010s, Mangaluru evolved into a comprehensive digital economy cluster with global linkages. Strategic investments in infrastructure, such as the development of SEZs (Special Economic Zones) and enhancement of port and airport facilities, improved connectivity for exports and talent mobility. Increasing collaborations between industry and academia fostered innovation, while accelerators and co-working hubs multiplied.

2015 onwards: Recognition as India's First Startup District

Mangaluru earned the distinction as India's first officially recognized Startup District by the Government of India, highlighting the cluster's strong entrepreneurial culture. This period saw exponential growth in the number of startups, GCCs, and specialized Centers of Excellence, catalyzing technology-driven economic transformation and raising the region's profile on the national stage.

2020: Digital Resilience and Strategic Realignment

The onset of the COVID-19 pandemic underscored Mangaluru's digital resilience, as many IT, fintech, and healthcare startups rapidly adapted to remote working models. The cluster began aligning more closely with the Beyond Bengaluru mission, focusing on inclusive growth and attracting diversified investments, positioning itself as a key pillar of Karnataka's digital economy roadmap.

WHY MANGALURU CLUSTER?



The Mangaluru cluster, encompassing Dakshina Kannada, Udupi, Uttara Kannada, and Kodagu districts, stands out as a vibrant and promising region within Karnataka. Recognized for its business-friendly environment, this cluster ranks fourth out of 37 districts in Deloitte's Ease of Doing Business (EODB) index, reflecting the conducive ecosystem for investment and growth. The cluster benefits from strategic multimodal connectivity, including excellent air, rail, road, and port infrastructure, facilitating efficient movement of people and goods. With a high literacy rate of 94% and a Human Development Index (HDI) score of 0.85, the region offers a skilled and educated workforce ready to support burgeoning industries.

Mangaluru's designation as a Smart City has catalyzed its evolution into a dynamic, tech-driven economy. Currently, the cluster generates a technology output of approximately ₹4,500 crore, employing over 10,000 IT professionals across diverse sectors. This growth is fueled by a strong academic base, with more than 25 engineering colleges delivering around 60,000 graduates annually, alongside 15+ incubation centers that nurture startups and foster innovation. The expanding office infrastructure, with more than 3.35 lakh square feet of space and an additional 5 lakh square feet under development, provides the physical foundation for the cluster's tech ecosystem to flourish.

This blend of robust infrastructure, skilled talent, and forward-looking governance positions Mangaluru as a rising hub for the digital economy. As the cluster continues its rapid technological and entrepreneurial development, it exemplifies the vision of distributed growth beyond metropolitan centers, contributing significantly to Karnataka's digital future. With ongoing investments and initiatives, Mangaluru is poised to expand its impact on both regional and global scales, emerging as a prime destination for technology companies, startups, and innovation-driven enterprises alike.

Key Enablers for Mangaluru's Growth:

1

Strategic Connectivity

Air, rail, road, and sea links, including a major port, facilitate seamless trade and business operations.

2

Robust Talent Pool

Over 60,000 engineering and degree students from 25+ institutions ensure a steady supply of skilled professionals.

3

Strong Educational Ecosystem

Premier colleges and training centers equip the workforce with relevant technical and managerial skills.

4

Infrastructure Expansion

Growing office spaces and incubation centres provide essential facilities for IT and tech companies.

5

Government Support

Smart City initiatives and supportive policies promote innovation, ease of doing business, and sustainable growth.

6

Thriving Start-up Culture

A conducive environment for entrepreneurship driven by multiple incubation centres and access to capital.

FUTURE VISION

Towards a
Sustainable
Tech Powerhouse

By 2034, the Mangaluru cluster aims to solidify its position as a leading coastal tech hub with an emphasis on sustainable and inclusive growth. The vision includes expanding the tech export footprint, creating direct digital jobs, and fostering innovation in emerging technologies. With continuous infrastructure development, enhanced connectivity, and policy support, Mangaluru is poised to become a model for tech-led economic transformation among coastal regions in India.

MANGALURU CLUSTER ROADMAP TO GLOBAL LEADERSHIP BY 2030

Target of Mangaluru cluster

The overarching objective is to conduct a comprehensive analysis of the macro and micro challenges and opportunities inherent in the Mangaluru region and to systematically address them in order to shape a targeted vision for the cluster by 2034. The aim is to create a detailed roadmap that not only attracts large enterprises to establish a significant presence but also amplifies the current workforce manifold, positioning Mangaluru as a leading coastal tech hub.

This report aspires to unlock the immense potential of the Mangaluru cluster by implementing a holistic strategy that leverages its existing strengths—skilled talent, institutional depth, and strategic connectivity—to transform the region into a vibrant node of the digital economy



Cluster productization highlights

Focus Area	Strength	Areas of Improvement/shortfall
Start-ups and innovation	- Investment-friendly policies have created a strong ecosystem for entrepreneurs, with over 200 startups present. - Presence of 15+ accelerators offers a strong platform innovation across streams - Rapidly growing tech landscape with many start-ups operating in the space.	- Aggressive, targeted and sustainable tax incentives and subsidies are necessary to lure IT/ITES and start-ups and smaller companies. - Need to promote innovation and entrepreneurship by hosting industry events and conferences - Diaspora outreach to get them to startup from their roots
GCC	- Has the foundational presence of one large company and 25+ satellite offices. - Major contributor of tech exports (accounted for Rs. 4,500 crores worth of exports) - Over 2000+ experienced professionals willing to come back if the right opportunities exist	- Lack of collaborations with industry stakeholders required to enhance its GCC profile - Absence of major brand satellite offices in the cluster is notable.
IT/ITeS	- Presence of tech giants like Tech Mahindra, Cognizant, Mphasis, and Infosys have fuelled Mangaluru's IT boom. - Solid presence of companies including Niveus, robosoft Technologies, Novigo, and Glowtouch - Mangaluru boasts of three SEZs in the region indicating a strong and established ecosystem	- Focus on building a comprehensive ecosystem for tech companies that fulfils all its needs for sustained growth that will allow to Elevate Mangaluru's IT/ITeS sector from established to mature - Lack of foreign MNCs operating within the tech areas such as IT/ITES, Fintech, and Edtech space
Talent	- Fresh engineering talent is available along with existing talent pool of 25,000+ - Availability of strong workforce in the areas of IT, BPM, and Application development & maintenance	Educational and training institutions should collaborate to develop more skill enhancement and reskilling programs aimed at enhancing the skill set of the local workforce
Branding	- Mangaluru is already a recognized cluster of IT/ITeS - Mangaluru is already renowned for its excellent talent pool	Need to organize a greater number of PR and marketing activities in the region
Governance	Presence of formal organization like KDEM and Silicon Beach Program to oversee policy formulation and execution	Need for focused approach tailored for the cluster similar to tier 1 city Bangalore-like initiatives for growth
Infrastructure	- Strong in terms of IT infrastructure, as well as Commercial and residential infrastructure. - Very well connected by air, sea and road. Connects to major cities across India	- Need for state-of-the-art industrial parks and technology zones to attract companies and foster innovation - Need for uninterrupted connectivity to middle east hubs for onward global connectivity.

Vision for HDB Cluster (For 2031-32)

	2024	2026	2028	2031	2034
Number of Tech employees	20,000	30,000	50,000	100,000	200,000
No. of Startups	200+	400+	1,000+	2,000+	4,000+
No. of Employees in Startups	2,000	4,000	10,000	20,000	40,000
No. of satellite offices	25+	50+	100+	150+	225+
No. of Employees in Satellite Offices	2,500	5,000	10,000	15,000	22,500
No. of Large Companies	1	5	10	15	25
No. of Employees in Large Companies	15,000	25,000	50,000	75,000	125,000
Tech output (in Crore ₹)	3,000+	5,000+	10,000+	20,000+	40,000+

Revenue Calculation for the Cluster

To estimate revenue generation for the IT cluster, we typically use the following approach:

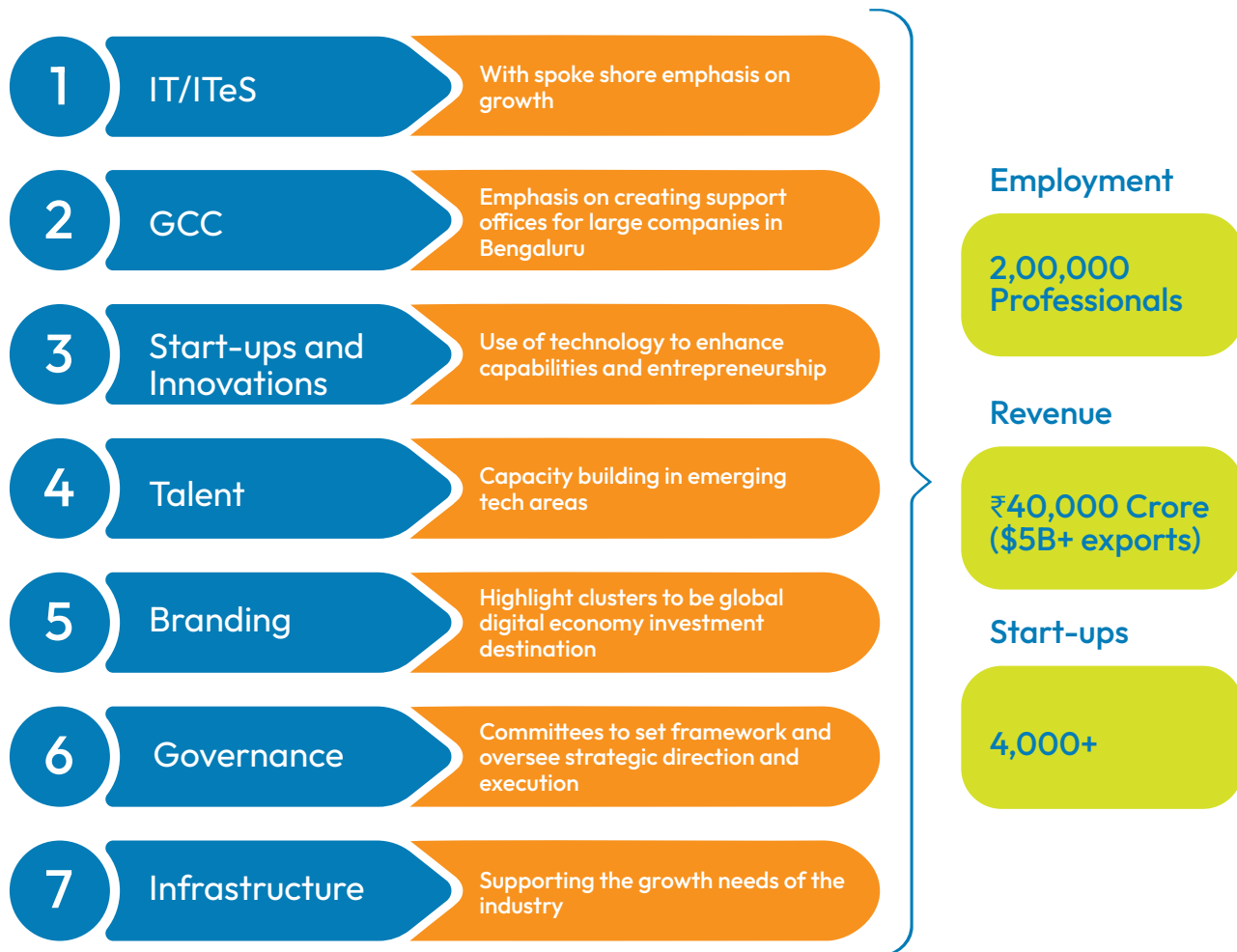
Estimate the Average Revenue per Employee (RPE):

- Large IT Companies: 10 lakhs per year
- Startups: 5 lakhs per year
- Satellite Offices: 8 lakhs per year

Revenue Projections for Mangaluru Cluster (in INR)

Target Year	Category	Number of Companies	Employment	Average Revenue per Employee (in INR)	Total Revenue (Lower Estimate) (in INR)
2026	Large IT Companies	5	25,000	10 lakhs	2,500 crores
	Satellite Offices	50+	5,000	8 lakhs	400 crores
	Startups	400+	4,000	5 lakhs	200 crores
	Total Revenue				3,100 crores
2028	Large IT Companies	10	50,000	10 lakhs	5,000 crores
	Satellite Offices	100+	10,000	8 lakhs	800 crores
	Startups	1,000+	10,000	5 lakhs	500 crores
	Total Revenue				6,300 crores
2031	Large IT Companies	15	75,000	10 lakhs	7,500 crores
	Satellite Offices	150+	15,000	8 lakhs	1,200 crores
	Startups	2,000+	20,000	5 lakhs	1,000 crores
	Total Revenue				9,700 crores
2034	Large IT Companies	25	125,000	10 lakhs	12,500 crores
	Satellite Offices	225+	22,500	8 lakhs	1,800 crores
	Startups	4,000+	40,000	5 lakhs	2,000 crores
	Total Revenue				16,300 crores

Mangaluru Cluster Roadmap to global leadership by 2034



The aspirations, targets, and recommendations outlined for each category have been strategically designed to catalyze growth and development across the vital sectors identified within the Mangaluru cluster. These tailored initiatives aim to foster innovation, enhance competitiveness, and promote sustainable practices within the cluster's ecosystem.

ENCOURAGING INNOVATION IN MANGALURU: STARTUP ESSENTIALS



The Mangaluru cluster, recognized as India's first Start-up District, has emerged as a vibrant hub for innovation and entrepreneurship, offering a conducive environment backed by government support. With over 200 start-ups serving 1000+ clients across 20+ countries, and a vision to reach 4,000+ start-ups by 2034, the region is fostering cross-industry collaboration across sectors like BFSI, Healthcare, Logistics, IT, FinTech, EdTech, and Gaming. Anchored by key incubation centres such as STPI Derebail, Manipal, Sahyadri, K-Tech, CEOL, NITK STEP, MITE, and Yenepoya, Mangaluru is rapidly advancing its ecosystem. CoE initiatives like the Honeywell CoE at Sahyadri and three NEP-aligned CoEs at NITK Surathkal underscore the focus on skill development, research, and innovation. These efforts are central to positioning Mangaluru as a major driver of investment, job creation, and emerging tech-led growth in the region.

Key recommendations from KDEM and estimated timeline for implementation

- 1. Organize domain-specific pitching events:** Quarterly pitching events like Mangaluru BLUE; government to fund VC travel; support market access and visibility for winners.
 - **Timeline:** 2025
- 2. Conduct regular hackathons:** Identify and support 10 start-ups per domain; encourage innovation at the cluster level.
 - **Timeline:** 2025
- 3. Cultivating a founder mindset (CoE as Catalyst):** EnaOrganize founder talks, establish a 30,000–40,000 sq. ft. CoE-driven Entrepreneurship Hub, and partner with TiE Mangaluru to promote entrepreneurship among youth.
 - **Timeline:** 2026
- 4. Establish a Cluster-level ELEVATE Program:** Funding support for 20 start-ups per cluster via ₹10 Cr/₹5 Cr fund in partnership with Department of IT/Bt and TiE Mangaluru by **2026**.
 - **Timeline:** 2026
- 5. Empower HNIs to become angel investors:** Hand-holding programs by TiE Mangaluru to develop local angel investors.
 - **Timeline:** 2027
- 6. Bridging the tech skill gap:** Partner with academia for industry-aligned tech courses; conduct targeted workshops for professionals.
 - **Timeline:** 2027
- 7. Fostering Co-founding with Tier 1 Cities (CoE as Matchmaker):** Create a CoE-facilitated platform connecting Mangaluru (Tier 2) founders with Tier 1 founders; provide support services for co-founded start-ups.
 - **Timeline:** 2028
- 8. Create a Mangaluru start-up grid:** A unified platform for start-ups, incubators, and mentors; enable networking events and masterclasses in collaboration with TiE Mangaluru.
 - **Timeline:** 2029
- 9. Create a Fund of Funds for Tier 2 cities:** ₹100 Cr fund (30% govt. up to ₹5 Cr, 70% from HNIs) to invest in start-up funds from Tier 2 cities like Mangaluru.
 - **Timeline:** 2030

Typical budget required to develop ESDM cluster

Category	Total (INR Crores)	Remarks
Infrastructure Development	500	Development of startup hubs, coworking spaces, and incubation centers and creation of shared facilities such as data centers, testing labs, and digital libraries.
Skill Development & Talent Pool	100	To organise workshops and certifications in emerging technologies (AI, blockchain, etc.) and collaboration with universities for start-up-specific curricula.
Startup Incentives	450	To support with seed funding, tax rebates, and zero-interest loans and mentorship programs and networking events.
Innovation & R&D Grants	145	To support with grants for product innovation and patenting and support for high-impact R&D projects and collaborations.
Marketing & Promotions	40	Plan national and international roadshows to attract investors and branding initiatives to position Mangaluru as a global startup hub.
Administrative & Operational Costs	125	Salaries for operational staff and management and maintenance of startup infrastructure.
Total Budget	1.360	

DEVELOPING GCCS IN THE MANGALURU CLUSTER



Mangaluru is rapidly emerging as a Global Capability Center (GCC) hub, driven by strong infrastructure, cost advantages, and supportive policies. With exports reaching ₹4,500 crores and the backing of the Spoke-Shore initiative, the cluster is fostering domain-specific GCCs in BFSI, petroleum, healthcare, and logistics. MRPL's 15 MMT capacity, a skilled finance and healthcare talent pool, and a strategic port location strengthen its sectoral appeal. To accelerate GCC growth, Mangaluru must attract targeted investments and position itself as a cost-effective, skilled destination. With a vision of 225+ satellite offices by 2034, the cluster is primed to serve as an engineering, R&D, and services hub for global enterprises.

Key recommendations from KDEM and estimated timeline for implementation

- 1. Leverage alumni networks and industry anchors:** The Silicon Beach Program, along with TiE Mangaluru and Kanara Chamber of Commerce & Industry (KCCI), drives tech ecosystem growth in Mangaluru by fostering innovation, entrepreneurship, and investment. They facilitate collaboration among industry, academia, and government, supporting startups, talent development, and infrastructure expansion. Through initiatives like the diaspora-engaging HomeComing program and targeted branding, they enhance the region's global visibility. Together, these efforts position Mangaluru as a rising technology hub and key contributor to Karnataka's digital economy.
 - **Timeline:** 2026
- 2. Targeted outreach strategy:** Develop a two-pronged strategy: target satellite offices of large corporations in BFSI, petroleum & natural gas, healthcare, and logistics for employment generation; simultaneously foster high-growth start-ups with cluster partners like TiE.
 - **Timeline:** 2027
- 3. Leveraging data analytics for healthcare and petroleum & natural gas GCCs:** Encourage partnerships between academia and industry to build data science and domain-specific expertise, focusing on healthcare informatics and oil & gas analytics by **2028**.
 - **Timeline:** 2028
- 4. Strategic partnerships with local giants in specific domain areas:** Collaborate with local corporations like MRPL and Manipal Group to establish back-office operations by promoting Mangaluru's cost advantages and talent availability.
 - **Timeline:** 2030

Typical budget required to develop IT/ ITES cluster

Category	Total (Rs. crore)	Remarks
1. Infrastructure Setup	750	- Establishing IT parks, business zones, and dedicated GCC hubs. - Modern office spaces with advanced facilities to attract multinational firms.
2. Talent & Workforce Development	340	- Training programs for BFSI, healthcare, logistics, and petroleum sectors. - Partnerships with universities and skill development agencies to meet GCC demands.
3. GCC Investment Promotion	525	- Global roadshows and summits to attract foreign direct investment (FDI). - Incentives for early-stage GCC setups to establish a foothold in Mangaluru.
4. Policy Incentives for GCCs	400	- Tax rebates, reduced utility rates, and subsidies for early movers. - Exclusive support for critical GCC domains like petroleum and healthcare.
5. Technology & Digital Upgrades	300	- Adoption of cloud computing, cybersecurity, and AI-driven tools. - Dedicated resources for digital transformation and operational efficiency.
6. Administrative & Operational Costs	115	- Salaries for cluster management staff and consultants. - Maintenance of shared infrastructure and operational support.
Total Annual Budget	2,430	

STRATEGISING THE GROWTH PROSPECTS OF IT/ITES IN MANGALURU CLUSTER



The Mangaluru cluster is becoming a key player in Karnataka's IT/ITES sector, with around 20,000 tech professionals, including 5,000 in large IT firms. The cluster hosts a growing mix of SMEs, startups, and corporates, supported by about 450,000 sq. ft. of IT space under development across three upcoming parks, including a government-backed IT park. Mangaluru is also emerging as a launchpad for innovation, offering mentorship, funding access, and a conducive environment for tech startups.

To position Mangaluru as a leading IT/ITES hub, efforts must focus on attracting tech-oriented SMEs, expanding R&D collaborations, and nurturing homegrown innovation. Timely completion of IT parks, investment in high-speed connectivity, secure data centers, and collaborative hubs are crucial to support scalable operations and achieve the goal of ₹40,000 crores in tech output by 2034, especially in sectors like BFSI and petroleum.

Key recommendations from KDEM and estimated timeline for implementation

- 1. Collaborative training in skills:** Forge industry-academia partnerships for specialized IT curricula; roll out targeted skill-development workshops with corporate partners; and implement talent-retention programs (competitive pay, career paths, community).
 - **Timeline:** 2026
- 2. Encourage innovation and entrepreneurship:** Establish a dedicated incubator offering funding, mentorship, and co-working space; organize sector-focused conferences and hackathons; and invest in R&D through grants and joint university research projects.
 - **Timeline:** 2026
- 3. Targeted investment strategies:** Design investor incentive packages tailored to tech start-ups and SMEs (tax breaks, subsidized rent, R&D grants) and develop specialized IT parks with high-security data centers, collaborative workspaces, and university proximity.
 - **Timeline:** 2028

Typical budget required to develop IT/ ITES cluster (in INR Crores)

Category	Amount
1. Infrastructure Development	425
2. Skill Development and Talent Pool	60
3. Incentives for Companies	155
4. Marketing and Promotion	20
5. Administrative and Operational Costs	140
Total Annual Budget	800

DEVELOPING STRATEGIES TO NURTURE SKILLS FOR KEY FOCUS INDUSTRIES

Mangaluru, long regarded as India's talent capital, is home to over 225 tech companies and 20,000 tech employees, including 5,000 in large firms and 2,500 in satellite offices. With ambitions to scale the workforce to 1,25,000 in large companies, 40,000 in startups, and 22,500 in satellite offices by 2034, the cluster must strengthen its position as a premier talent hub. This requires competitive salaries, career growth opportunities, and expanding the talent pool into emerging sectors like Fintech, BFSI, healthcare, petroleum, and logistics through academia-industry collaborations. Emphasis on multilingual skills (e.g., Japanese, Mandarin, Spanish, Arabic), targeted upskilling, startup support, and inclusive hiring practices will be key to building a dynamic, future-ready workforce

Key recommendations from KDEM and estimated timeline for implementation

- Industry-Academia collaboration:** Companies to adopt colleges within their domain and co-develop practical, industry-aligned curriculums.
 - Timeline:** 2026
- Flexibility in minor degrees for autonomous colleges:** Enable colleges to offer minor degrees aligned with industry needs, enhancing employability.
 - Timeline:** 2026
- Master trainer development and language training programs:** Train 100 master trainers (25 in each domain) and offer German, Spanish, and Japanese language programs.
 - Timeline:** 2027

Budget Plan for Developing Skilled Talent Ecosystem (in INR Crores)

Category	Total (Rs. crore)	Remarks
Faculty Training & Development	35	Upskilling faculty and educators in new technologies and teaching methods.
Career Services & Placement Support	50	Enhancing job placement services, organizing job fairs, and industry tie-ups.
Marketing & Community Outreach	20	Promotion of skill development programs and awareness campaigns.
Research & Analytics	25	Continuous assessment of program effectiveness and skill demand analysis.
Operational & Administrative Costs	30	Staff salaries, utilities, and other operational expenses.
Faculty Training & Development	35	Upskilling faculty and educators in new technologies and teaching methods.

Category	Total (Rs. crore)	Remarks
Career Services & Placement Support	50	Enhancing job placement services, organizing job fairs, and industry tie-ups.
Marketing & Community Outreach	20	Promotion of skill development programs and awareness campaigns.
Research & Analytics	25	Continuous assessment of program effectiveness and skill demand analysis.
Operational & Administrative Costs	30	Staff salaries, utilities, and other operational expenses.
Total		450

DEVELOP MANGALURU AS THE 'SILICON BEACH OF INDIA' - TALENT HUB TO TECHNOLOGY HUB

The initiative to develop Mangaluru as the 'Silicon Beach of India' envisions transforming the region from its traditional identity as the 'Cradle of Banking' and 'Ice Cream Capital' into a vibrant, modern technology hub. Leveraging its strategic location, skilled talent pool, growing start-up ecosystem, and robust infrastructure, the Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM) is collaborating closely with the Silicon Beach Program (SBP) to spearhead this transformation.

This involves a comprehensive rebranding strategy that uses targeted digital marketing, social media campaigns, and public relations to reposition Mangaluru as a tech-savvy, innovation-driven destination. The Silicon Beach Program plays a critical role in amplifying the city's global visibility, attracting investments as well as talent, and fostering an entrepreneurial culture. Through concerted efforts in brand building, infrastructure development, and strategic partnerships, Mangaluru is poised to emerge as India's leading Technology hub while offering an attractive ecosystem for startups and established enterprises alike.

Key recommendations from KDEM and estimated timeline for implementation

1. Create a website for the Silicon Beach of India

- **Remarks:** Acts as a central digital platform to showcase success stories, connect stakeholders (mentors, investors, startups), and promote the region's tech potential. Work with SBP – update accordingly.
- **Silicon Beach Program Role:** SBP will provide strategic inputs on content curation, manage stakeholder engagement features, and facilitate regular updates on ongoing initiatives to enhance platform dynamism and visibility.
- **Timeline:** 2025

2. Unified branding and targeted marketing:

- **Remarks:** Establishes a cohesive brand identity (logo, tagline, visual theme) and supports targeted outreach to talent and investors through campaigns leveraging the website and other platforms. – Work with SBP.
- **Silicon Beach Program Role:** SBP will collaborate closely with marketing agencies, design communication toolkits, and spearhead digital and social media campaigns targeting national and international investor and talent pools.
- **Timeline:** 2026

3. Host industry-specific events and summits:

- **Remarks:** Organizes regular conferences, workshops, and hackathons focused on key domains to foster knowledge exchange, collaboration, and visibility at the national and international level.
- **Silicon Beach Program Role:** SBP will coordinate event planning, bring in international speakers, facilitate networking sessions, and leverage global partnerships to maximize event impact and outreach.
- **Timeline:** 2027

4. Targeted roadshows and participation:

- **Remarks:** Conducts focused promotional roadshows and participates in industry events in India and Middle East, leveraging early traction from Saudi roadshow where 3 firms expressed interest.
- **Silicon Beach Program Role:** SBP will organize roadshows, liaise with regional industry forums and government missions, customize pitches to investor profiles, and assist in lead follow-ups and partnership building
- **Timeline:** 2028

Estimated Budget Allocation (2025-2028)

Category	Key Activities	Estimated Cost (₹ Crores)
Branding and Marketing	Developing a central website ("Silicon Beach of India")	2.5
	Branding elements (logo, tagline, visuals)	1.0
	Digital marketing campaigns and PR outreach	4.0
	Roadshows and event participation (India and Middle East)	5.0
	Industry-specific events and summits (4 annual events)	8.0
Subtotal		20.5
Infrastructure Support	Creation of IT hubs/incubators in Mangaluru and Udupi	25.0
	Dedicated co-working spaces and collaboration zones	10.0
	High-speed internet infrastructure enhancement	15.0
	Technology innovation labs	8.0
Subtotal		58.0
Talent Development	Skilling programs in partnership with universities	10.0
	Training centers for certifications in emerging technologies	5.0
Subtotal		15.0
Strategic Partnerships	Collaborations with NASSCOM and GCCs	3.0
	Industry-academia research partnerships	2.5
Subtotal		5.5
Governance and Policy Support	Establishing a single-window clearance system	2.0
	Administrative and operational costs for implementation	1.5
Subtotal		3.5
Grand Total		102.5

ESTABLISHING MANGALURU AS A GLOBAL AI DATA CENTER HUB

Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM), under its Beyond Bengaluru initiative, envisions positioning Mangaluru as a strategic hub for next-generation Data Centers. Leveraging its coastal advantage, emerging digital infrastructure, renewable energy ecosystem, and talent base, Mangaluru will complement Bengaluru as a 'Bangalore+1' location while serving as a resilient backup site for global capability centers (GCCs).

3.1. STRATEGIC RATIONALE

- **Location Advantage:** Coastal city with access to ports, logistics, and potential submarine cable landing stations.
- **Resilience & Security:** Low seismic risk, geographic insulation from high-risk borders.
- **Digital Readiness:** Growing fiber connectivity, renewable energy capacity, and strong IT/ITES presence.
- **Talent Ecosystem:** Proximity to academic institutions, availability of skilled workforce, and scope for specialized DC upskilling programs.

3.2. CORE OBJECTIVES

1. **Market Leadership** – Position Karnataka as India's premier AI-driven Data Center hub.
2. **Infrastructure Development** – Secure scalable land parcels, reliable green power, and high-capacity connectivity.
3. **Policy Innovation** – Benchmark and enhance Karnataka's Data Center policy to offer globally competitive incentives.
4. **Ecosystem Enablement** – Build partnerships across EPCs, OEMs, operators, hyperscalers, and submarine cable providers.
5. **Talent & Employment** – Create local employment, develop AI/data infra expertise, and retain talent in coastal Karnataka.

3.3. STRATEGIC ROADMAP

- **Short Term (0–2 years):** Feasibility validation, pilot DC setups, submarine cable landing plan.
- **Medium Term (2–5 years):** Cluster development with multi-tenant DC parks, policy rollouts, renewable energy integration.
- **Long Term (5–10 years):** Global positioning of Mangaluru as a 1 GW+ Data Center cluster serving AI, cloud, and digital economy growth.

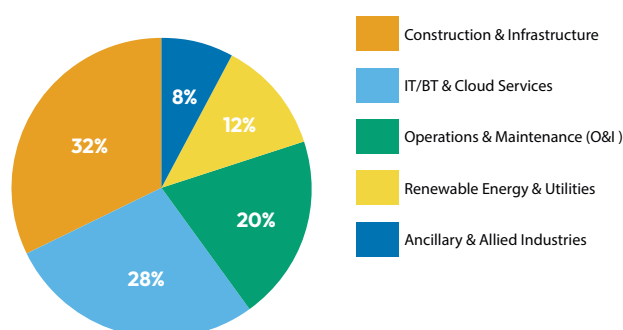
3.4. EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- **Job Creation:** Establishing the Mangaluru DC hub is expected to generate over 25,000 direct and indirect jobs across multiple sectors:
 - **Construction & Infrastructure:** ~8,000 jobs (civil works, electrical, cooling, logistics).
 - **IT/BT & Cloud Services:** ~7,000 jobs (data center operations, AI infra management, cloud engineering).
 - **Operations & Maintenance (O&M):** ~5,000 jobs (facilities management, power systems, security).
 - **Renewable Energy & Utilities:** ~3,000 jobs (green power projects, grid integration, cooling solutions).
 - **Ancillary & Allied Industries:** ~2,000 jobs (transport, food, services, SMEs in the DC ecosystem).
- **Attraction of multi-billion-dollar investments** in DC infrastructure.
- **Positioning Karnataka** to contribute significantly to India's USD 1 trillion digital economy vision.
- **Job creation across IT/BT, construction, O&M, and AI-driven innovation.**
- **Establishment of Mangaluru** as a globally recognized, sustainable, and future-ready Data Center hub.

3.5. INFOGRAPHIC: JOB CREATION IN MANGALURU REGION

The following infographic highlights the sector-wise job distribution expected from the development of the Mangaluru AI Data Center Hub, contributing to more than 25,000 direct and indirect jobs in the region.

Mangaluru DC Hub - Job Creation Breakdown (25,000 Jobs)



3.6. REGIONAL IMPACT OF MANGALURU DATA CENTER HUB

The establishment of the Mangaluru AI Data Center Hub will significantly impact the regional economy, infrastructure, and employment landscape, making the city a strategic contributor to Karnataka's digital growth.

- **GDP Contribution:** Expected to add over USD 2–3 billion annually to Karnataka's economy once fully operational.
- **Employment:** More than 25,000 direct and indirect jobs will uplift local households and retain young talent in the region.
- **Allied Industry Growth:** Boost to logistics, hospitality, construction, renewable energy, and MSMEs in coastal Karnataka.
- **Academic Linkages:** Collaboration with universities in and around Mangaluru to create specialized curricula for AI, cloud, and DC management.
- **Talent Retention:** Reducing the migration of skilled professionals to Bengaluru and other metros by creating high-value jobs locally.
- **Global Branding:** Positioning Mangaluru as a world-class technology and sustainability-driven coastal hub.

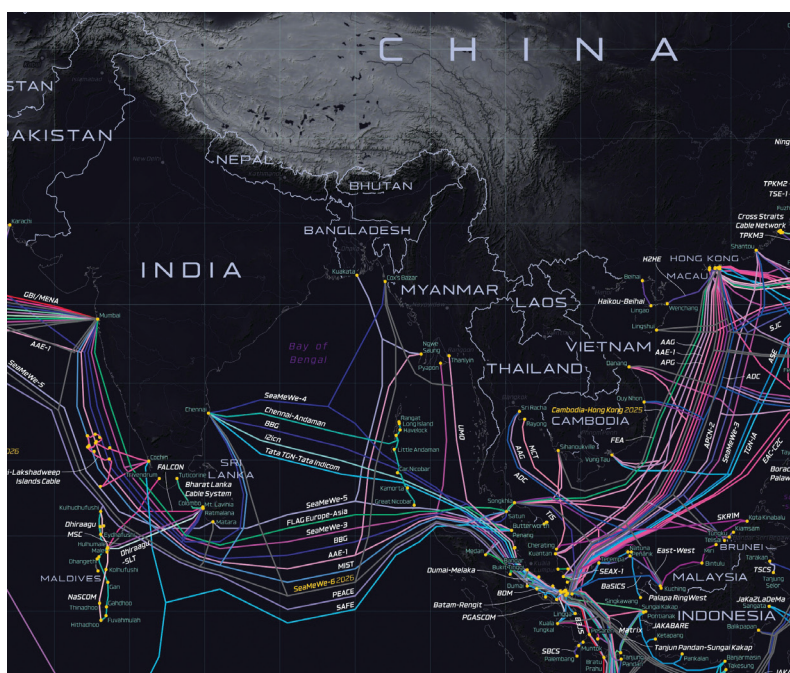
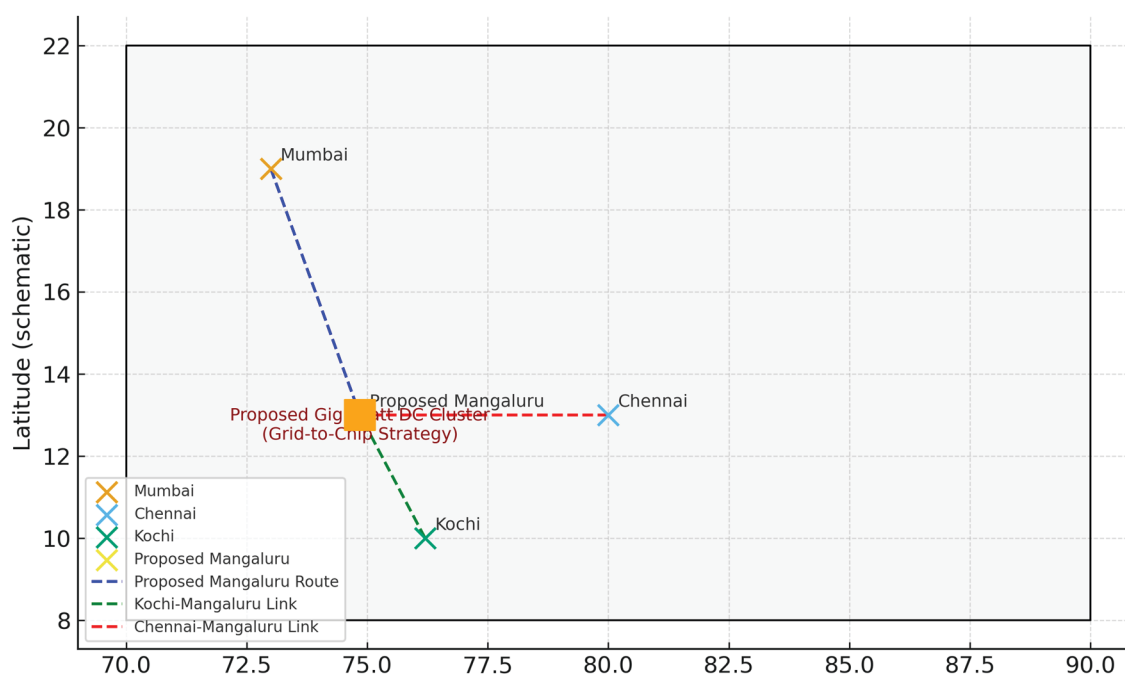
3.7. UNDERSEA CABLE CONNECTIVITY PROPOSAL

To strengthen Mangaluru's positioning as a global Data Center hub, undersea cable connectivity will be a critical enabler. Direct landing stations and subsea cable routes will provide low-latency, high-capacity international bandwidth, making the hub globally competitive for hyperscalers, cloud providers, and AI-driven enterprises.

- **Strategic Advantage:** Establish Mangaluru as India's next submarine cable landing station on the western coast, reducing dependency on Mumbai and Chennai routes.
- **Global Reach:** Enable direct connections to Middle East, Europe, and Southeast Asia through new subsea cable corridors.
- **Resilience:** Provide redundancy for India's data traffic, enhancing security and disaster recovery capabilities.
- **Investment Potential:** Attract hyperscalers, telecom providers, and consortium-led investments into coastal Karnataka.
- **Integration:** Align with national digital infrastructure plans and Karnataka's Beyond Bengaluru initiative for global competitiveness.

3.8. PROPOSED GIGAWATT DATA CENTERS & GRID-TO-CHIP STRATEGY

Mangaluru is envisioned as a giga-scale data center cluster, with planned capacity exceeding 1 GW over the next decade. The 'Grid-to-Chip' strategy ensures integration of renewable energy (wind, solar, hydro) with advanced cooling, high-density compute, and chip-level optimization for AI and cloud workloads.



3.9. PROPOSED CABLE ROUTE OPTIONS

OPTION 1: MIDDLE EAST & EUROPE ROUTE

- Route: Oman / UAE → Mangaluru → onward to Chennai / Singapore
- Leverage: Proximity to the FALCON, AAE-1, and EIG cables that currently terminate in Mumbai.
- Advantage: Direct low-latency path from Gulf and Europe, bypassing congested Mumbai landing stations.

OPTION 2: SOUTHEAST ASIA EXTENSION

- Route: Singapore → Colombo → Mangaluru → onward to Middle East / Africa
- Leverage: Taps into existing SEA-ME-WE-6 and IGG (India-Global Gateway) cables.
- Advantage: Provides a Bangalore+1 backup for hyperscalers routing traffic to Southeast Asia.

OPTION 3: REGIONAL LOOP WITH KOCHI & CHENNAI

- Route: Chennai ↔ Kochi ↔ Mangaluru (terrestrial + subsea loop)
- Leverage: Builds redundancy into existing SMW-4, SAFE, and Kochi landing systems.
- Advantage: Resilient triangular cable ring ensuring failover among three west/south landing points.

3.10. STRATEGIC BENEFITS FOR MANGALURU

- Latency Reduction: ~20–30 ms improvement for Europe and Middle East traffic into Southern India.
- Investment Magnet: Attracts hyperscalers (Google, Meta, AWS, Microsoft Azure) and carriers seeking redundant routes.
- Regional Development: Direct integration with Mangaluru GigaWatt DC Cluster → 'Cable-to-Cloud-to-Chip' model.
- National Security: De-risking reliance on Mumbai and Chennai, ensuring resilient national infrastructure.

3.11. NEXT STEPS

1. Commission pre-feasibility study with telcos (Reliance Jio, Airtel Nxtra, BSNL, and international cable consortia).
2. Identify landing site near Mangalore Port / SEZ with integrated Cable Landing Station (CLS) + DC park.
3. Explore PPP / consortium-led investment with state incentives.
4. Align with Government of India's Digital Communication Infrastructure plan for strategic approvals

THE MANGALURU MODEL

COLLABORATIVE GOVERNANCE FOR EFFECTIVE CLUSTER GROWTH

Effective governance is the backbone of sustained cluster development. The **Mangaluru cluster** the cluster follows a collaborative model that brings together the **government, industry leaders, and community stakeholders** to align goals and drive progress. At the core of this approach is an **Executive Committee** led by key industry figures, ensuring shared ownership, transparency, and smooth execution.

Key Objectives for the Cluster

Chart a Strategic Course

Define a long-term development path for the HDB cluster aligned with Karnataka's digital economy roadmap. Key responsibilities include prioritizing target sectors (IT/ITES, GCCs, Startups), setting investment goals, job creation benchmarks, and infrastructure milestones.

Foster Continuous Improvement

Introduce impact-driven governance by tracking outcomes using quantifiable metrics. Regular reviews by the Governing Body will drive data-informed decisions and iterative improvements in program design and delivery.

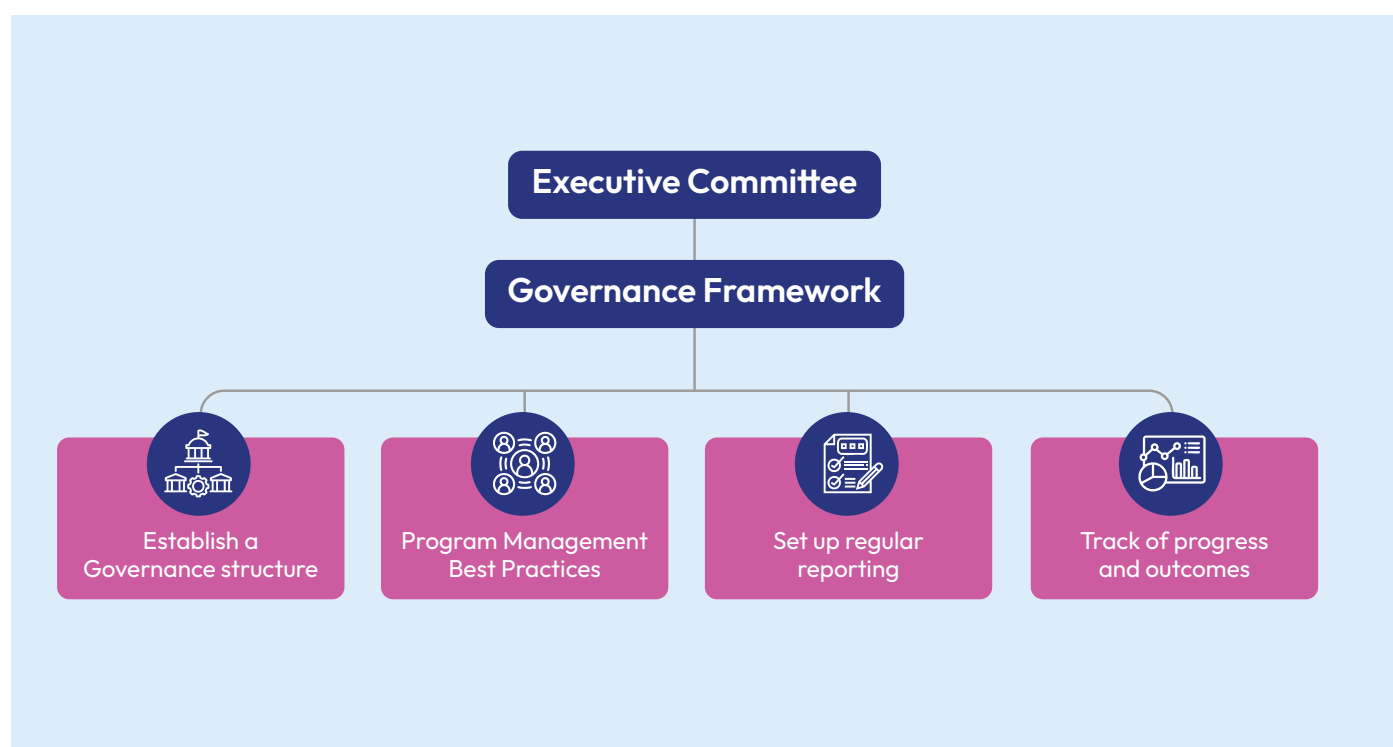
Key recommendations from KDEM

- 1. Establish a Clear Governance Framework:** Define stakeholder roles (KDEM, govt., industry, academia), SOPs for planning, decision-making, and conflict resolution to streamline coordination.
 - **Timeline:** 2025-26
- 2. Implement Program Management Guidelines:** Standardize initiative design, budgeting, risk management, and evaluation to improve execution across cluster projects.
 - **Timeline:** 2025-26
- 3. Enable Real-Time Reporting & Monitoring:** Deploy dashboards tracking GCCs, startups, investments, jobs, and policy implementation; generate quarterly and bi-annual reports for internal and public use.
 - **Timeline:** 2025-26
- 4. Prioritize Transparency and Ecosystem Trust:** Publicly share progress updates and budgets; create feedback loops to include input from startups, investors, and academia for a collaborative governance system.
 - **Timeline:** 2025-26

Typical governance structure

Component	Chair	Composition	Key Role
Executive Committee	Lead Industry Anchor(s) from Mangaluru	Government officials, cluster partners, academia	Operationalize projects, resource deployment, execution oversight
Cluster Team (Ops)	Cluster Head (KDEM Mangaluru Lead)	PMU, consultants, industry program managers	Day-to-day management, reporting, liaison with stakeholders

Scope of Stakeholders



Executive Committee:

1. Set goals, objectives, and performance metrics for the program.
2. Execute the enterprise growth program according to the strategic direction set by the analysis report and governing body and detailed implementation plans, timelines, and deliverables.
3. Allocate financial and human resources to support the program's activities and allocate resources efficiently to achieve program objectives.
4. Advocate for the program and its impact on the local economy and community.
5. Collaborate with partners to leverage resources and expertise to support program objectives.
6. Collate and analyse data to measure program outcomes and impact.
7. Develop and implement a communication and outreach strategy to raise awareness of the program.
8. Promote the program's successes, achievements, and impact through various channels.

Constitution of Executive Committee

To be chaired by the lead industry anchors and nominated representatives from the clusters and the Government to meet every month at the clusters physically/virtually. The suggested date can be the 18th of every quarter of the year.

S. No.	Executive Committee	Role of the representative
1	Industry Anchor from each cluster	Convenor
2	CEO, KDEM	Co-Convenor
3	KUM, Department of I & C	Nominated member
4	Department of Skills	Nominated member
5	GM, IT Department	Nominated member
6	Labour Department	Nominated member
7	Nominated Industry member – 3 Cluster	3 members from Mysuru, Mangaluru and HDB
8	Nominated Industry Body	

Conclusion

Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi's (HDB's) governance model for cluster growth represents **a replicable and scalable template** for other emerging tech hubs in India. Its **multi-stakeholder, data-driven, and transparent approach** ensures that the **ambitions of economic development** are met with **clarity, collaboration, and consistency**.

By institutionalizing collaborative governance under KDEM's leadership, the HDB cluster is well-positioned to deliver measurable results in innovation, job creation, and global recognition.

REGIONAL SUCCESS STORIES FROM **MANGALURU CLUSTER**



1. Robosoft technologies

Robosoft Technologies, founded in 1996 by Rohith Bhat, is a pioneering digital transformation company that grew from the temple town of Udupi into a global technology leader. Beginning with Apple as its first customer, Robosoft quickly built credibility in international markets, even contributing five of the 200 apps launched on the first iPhone release day. Over the years, it expanded beyond Mac and mobile development into end-to-end digital consulting, engineering, UI/UX design, analytics, and transformation solutions, with 80% of its business now coming from global markets such as the US, Japan, and the UK. Recognized with prestigious awards including the Platinum Award at the TITAN Awards, the company reached \$42 million in annual revenues by 2021, growing rapidly at a 68% rate over 18 months. In 2021, Robosoft was acquired by Tokyo Stock Exchange-listed TechnoPro Holdings in a ₹805 crore deal, underscoring its global relevance and value. Today, under new leadership, Robosoft continues to drive digital innovation for enterprises worldwide, leveraging its engineering excellence, customer focus, and expertise in emerging areas such as AI, machine learning, and cloud computing.

2. Niveus Solutions

Niveus Solutions, founded in 2013 by former Infosys and Wipro professionals, has grown from a bootstrapped start-up into a multi-award-winning cloud engineering company. Leveraging the talent base of Udupi, Manipal, and Mangaluru, it became an exclusive Google Cloud India partner in 2019 and advanced to 'Premier' status within two years. Recognized with multiple Google Cloud Partner of the Year awards across Asia Pacific and India, and featured as a Major Contender in Everest Group's PEAK Matrix, Niveus has delivered transformative projects such as the Mahindra XUV 3XO and Thar ROXX digital launches and the Axis My India super app for 250 million users. Certified as a Great Place to Work in 2024, Niveus now strengthens NTT DATA's global cloud and AI capabilities following its acquisition in 2025, while continuing to build on its Mangaluru roots as a hub of innovation.

3. Novigo Solutions

Novigo Solutions, founded in 2013 in Mangaluru by Praveen Kumar Kalbhavi, Mohammed Hanif, Mohammed Jarood, and Shihab Kalandar, has grown from a regional start-up into a global IT services leader in intelligent automation, data analytics, and low-code development. Starting with a landmark U.S. credit union project, the company expanded rapidly through milestones such as acquiring Karanji Infotech in 2017, achieving Microsoft Gold Partner status, and securing CMMI Level 3 certification in 2018. With operations in 20+ countries and a client base including Fortune 500 enterprises, Novigo became UiPath's first diamond partner in APAC and earned recognition such as UiPath's "Commitment & Achievements Award." By FY25, it reported revenues of ₹264 crore with a 25% EBITDA margin and a workforce of 1,000. In August 2025, Blackstone-backed R Systems acquired Novigo for an upfront ₹400 crore with additional performance-linked payouts, valuing the deal at nearly ₹950 crore, underscoring its global impact and rapid growth.

SUMMARY OF EXPENDITURE

The Mangaluru Cluster Vision aims to build a globally competitive digital economy by driving growth in IT/ITES, GCCs, and startups. Achieving this requires a strong financial framework to ensure efficient and transparent use of funds across infrastructure, talent, technology, governance, and incentives.

This chapter outlines planned and projected expenditures across key areas, supporting accountability, progress tracking, and alignment with broader state and national goals

Category	Planned Expenditure	Actual/Projected Expenditure	Description
Infrastructure Development	₹500 Cr	₹450 Cr	Development of IT parks, logistics hubs, utilities, and shared infrastructure to house 100+ startups, 10+ GCCs, and large-scale tech operations.
Technology Enablement	₹200 Cr	₹180 Cr	Investment in advanced IT infrastructure, R&D labs, and data centers to support product development and scalability.
Talent Development	₹50 Cr	₹40 Cr	Digital skilling programs, CoEs, industry-academia partnerships, and faculty training in AI, Blockchain, IoT, and cybersecurity.
Marketing & Promotion	₹50 Cr	₹25 Cr	Branding via digital campaigns, investor roadshows, startup expos, and initiatives like #siliconbeachesofINDIA .
Administrative Costs	₹20 Cr	₹18 Cr	Governance management, staffing, compliance, and operational support for ongoing cluster programs.
Incentives/Subsidies	₹100 Cr	₹90 Cr	Support for startups, SMEs, and MNCs through rental subsidies, tax breaks, and grants under KDEM's Beyond Bengaluru program.



Key Financial Principles Guiding the Cluster:

- **Outcome-Oriented Budgeting:** Link funds with measurable results such as number of startups incubated, jobs created, or tech exports generated.
- **Stakeholder Co-ownership:** Encourage private contributions (land, infra, services) to complement public investment.
- **Mid-Term Revisions:** Periodic reviews to reallocate unspent budgets to high-performing programs or scale-up opportunities.
- **Sustainability Assurance:** A phased shift from capex-heavy funding to operating self-sustained through rentals, PPPs, and service fees.

Conclusion:

The ₹1,000 crore investment strategy for the Mangaluru cluster represents a well-calibrated, multi-sectoral roadmap that is closely aligned with Karnataka's state ambitions and global best practices. With ₹803 crore already allocated or expended, the cluster has achieved nearly 80% financial execution, demonstrating strong momentum and operational efficiency.

As the cluster scales further, this robust financial framework will ensure disciplined, data-driven, and outcome-focused implementation—positioning Mangaluru as a leading benchmark among India's emerging digital economy hubs.

POLICIES OF FUNDING

LEAP Fund for Karnataka

The Karnataka government has launched the LEAP (Local Economy Accelerator Program) Fund to strengthen innovation and entrepreneurship across the state, with a special focus on Beyond Bengaluru clusters such as Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi, Mysuru, Mangaluru, Kalaburagi, Tumakuru, and Shivamogga. With an initial outlay of ₹100 crore, the LEAP Fund is designed to support early-stage and scaling startups in emerging technology sectors like AI/ML, EVs, clean energy, drones, deeptech, and Industry 4.0. Funds will be allocated exclusively to startups that are registered and operating from Beyond Bengaluru regions, ensuring that the benefits directly contribute to regional economic growth and decentralisation of the innovation ecosystem. The funding will be deployed through a mix of grants, equity investments, and debt instruments in partnership with private investors, accelerators, and industry anchors. Startups will be selected via competitive calls and evaluated on innovation potential, scalability, and alignment with cluster priorities.

TBI 2.0 – Tech Business Incubator Expansion

Aligned with the state's Startup and Innovation policies, the Government of Karnataka has announced the expansion of Tech Business Incubators (TBI 2.0) across key clusters. This initiative will establish six new TBIs in IT/ITES, ESDM, and AI/ML verticals, and three TBIs in Biotech and Clean Energy, with an investment of ₹10 crore per incubator over five years. Recently, 11 new TBIs have been approved across the state, with locations spanning Beyond Bengaluru clusters, including at least one high-impact TBI in the HDB region. These TBIs will provide plug-and-play facilities, advanced prototyping labs, access to mentors and global experts, investor connect programs, and opportunities for startups to access national and international markets. Special focus will be placed on nurturing deeptech startups, fostering industry-academia collaboration, and promoting women-led enterprises in these innovation hubs.

List of Recently Announced 11 TBIs and Their Host Institutions

- 1. Technology Business Incubator NIE-TBI** – The National Institute of Engineering, Mysuru (Mobility, Defense System, Healthcare)
- 2. Technology Business Incubation Centre for Innovation and Entrepreneurship in Horticultural Biotechnology** – University of Horticultural Sciences, Bagalkot (Molecular Breeding, Genomics)
- 3. TBI – Yenepoya Foundation for Technology Incubation** – Yenepoya (Deemed to be University), Mangalore (AI and XR in Healthcare, Biomanufacturing and Pharma)
- 4. Anvesana Innovation and Entrepreneurial Forum** – PES Institute of Technology and Management, Shivamogga (Agriculture, Tourism, Health care)
- 5. DREAM (Dharwad Research & ECOSPACE for Advancing Minds) Technology** – Dharwad Institute of Mental Health and Neurosciences (Diagnostics, AI/ML/Pharmacogenomics)
- 6. VRIF's TBI** – Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi (IoT Products and Robotics, Computer Vision and AR/VR)
- 7. Technology Business Incubator – KLE** – KLE Technological University Dr. M. S. Sheshgiri Campus, Belagavi (Smart Healthcare & Medical Technologies (IoT), Sustainable Agri Tech and Smart Farming)
- 8. SCJE Science and Technology Entrepreneurs Park** – JSS Science and Technology University, Mysuru (IT/ITES, AI/ML, IoT)
- 9. SSAHE Innovation and Incubation Council** – Sri Siddhartha Academy of Higher Education, Tumkur (Health and Biopharma)
- 10. Technology Business Incubator – MCE** – Malnad College of Engineering, Hassan (AgriTech, HealthTech)
- 11. ROBIOT MMEC – TBI 2.0** – Maratha Mandal's – Engineering College, Belagavi (Agriculture Automation, Health and Wellness)

The HDB Cluster Vision aims to create a robust funding ecosystem by leveraging state and central government schemes, public-private partnerships, and private investments. By aligning with Karnataka's pro-investment policies and global funding opportunities, the cluster is set to emerge as a self-sustaining hub for innovation and growth. A dedicated focus on MSMEs, startups, and sustainable funding ensures the equitable distribution of resources, fostering inclusive development in the Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi region.

In order to attract investments within the cluster, Mangaluru has already adopted the following set of policies:

Sector	Scheme/Policy	Support/Focus Areas
Petroleum & Natural Gas	Hydrocarbon Exploration and Licensing Policy (HELP)	• Single license for all hydrocarbons (oil, gas, shale, CBM) • Transparent revenue-sharing model • Graded royalty rates & 7-year royalty holiday for deep/ultra-deep blocks • No cess on crude oil, customs duty exemption on equipment imports • Full pricing & marketing freedom • 12-year Reconnaissance Contracts (RCs) • Competitive bidding through frequent licensing rounds
	Sagarmala Programme (Infrastructure Support)	• Strengthens port-led infrastructure • Reduces logistics costs • Enhances oil & gas movement via Mangaluru port
Healthcare	Medical Device Parks Promotion	• Financial assistance up to ₹100 Cr (70% of project cost) • Support for shared infrastructure (labs, sterilization, 3D printing) Plug-and-play zones
	PLI Scheme for Medical Devices	• ₹3,420 Cr outlay to boost domestic manufacturing • Focus areas: radiology, diagnostics, implants, anaesthesia, etc. Incentives based on incremental annual production
Logistics	Sagarmala Programme	• Development of multimodal logistics hubs with coastal connectivity • ₹10.5 Lakh Cr+ in port, rail, road, and inland waterway projects
	Bharatmala Pariyojana	• Development of expressways, logistics corridors, and feeder routes • Promotion of private logistics parks and warehousing near Mangaluru
Start-ups & Innovation	High Risk – High Reward (SERB)	Full R&D grant support for breakthrough innovations
	PRISM (DSIR)	₹20 Lakhs for Proof of Concept (PoC) ₹50 Lakhs for scaling up innovations
	NewGen IEDC	₹25 Lakhs seed funding for college-based innovations
	SBIRI (BIRAC)	• Up to ₹50 Lakhs: 100% government support • Above ₹50 Lakhs: 50% grant with industry cost-sharing
	Karnataka Startup Policy (2022–27)	• Grants up to ₹50 Lakhs for early-stage startups • Incentives for women and student innovators (via NAIN centres) • ₹100 Cr VC Fund for deep-tech - Incubation, marketing, and acceleration support

Strategies: Policy Pillars

Pillar	Title	Key Initiatives / Support
Pillar 1	NAIN 2.0 – Innovation Network	50 new centres in govt. tech colleges outside Bengaluru ₹5L/project for up to 10 student projects/year ₹12L annual ops support ₹10L/year for external incubators
Pillar 2	TBIs 2.0 – Tech Business Incubators	Upcoming 6 new TBIs in IT/Electronics and 3 in Biotech Upto Rs.10 Cr/TBI over 5 years Focus on AI/ML, Blockchain, AR/VR and EV tech
Pillar 3	Funding for Startups	₹50L Idea2PoC Grant for Deep Tech, SDGs ₹100 Cr VC fund for AI, EVs, Drones, etc. Cluster Seed Fund for startups in HDB, Mysuru, Mangaluru
Pillar 4	Incubation & Acceleration Infrastructure	₹50L capital grant (max 50%) for new incubators ₹25L support to scale existing centres Acceleration Network + Virtual Incubation Platform
Pillar 5	Inclusive Ecosystem – Women Entrepreneurs	25% of ₹100 Cr VC fund for women Exclusive funding & Elevate Women program 20% seats in incubators reserved Loans up to ₹10L
Pillar 6	Social & Rural Entrepreneurship	₹15 Cr Rural Innovation Centre ₹1L internship subsidy/startup (up to 3 interns)
Pillar 7	Innovation for Societal Impact	Annual challenge calls: ₹10L seed + ₹50L follow-on funding CSR funding for SDG-aligned startups
Pillar 8	Governance & Ease of Doing Business	Simplified procedures via Startup Cell & Startup Portal 2.0 Trust-based startup facilitation

CONCLUSION AND THE WAY FORWARD



A Vision with Purpose

The **Draft Mangaluru Cluster Vision** is more than a roadmap—it is a strategic declaration of Mangaluru’s readiness to lead India’s next wave of inclusive, technology-led economic transformation. Grounded in its rich cultural heritage and academic excellence, Mangaluru is uniquely positioned to blend **heritage and high-tech**, becoming a **Emerging innovation capital** and a **model for decentralized digital growth** under Karnataka’s Beyond Bengaluru initiative.

This vision document brings together the aspirations, investments, and collective efforts of **government, industry, academia**, and **community** to realize a bold ambition: **positioning Mangaluru as India’s Silicon Beach of INDIA City** and one of the most sought-after destinations for **IT/ITES, startups, and Global Capability Centers (GCCs)**.

Call to Action for Stakeholders:

- **Government:** Continue to lead with policy innovation, investment incentives, and seamless clearances
- **Industry:** Anchor long-term growth by investing in infrastructure, mentoring startups, and hiring locally
- **Academia:** Serve as the knowledge partner—updating curricula, fostering R&D, and nurturing entrepreneurs
- **Startups & Entrepreneurs:** Leverage the robust support ecosystem and shape solutions for India and the world
- **Investors & VCs:** Explore Mangaluru’s untapped potential as a capital-efficient innovation ecosystem

Closing Note

Mangaluru has all the right ingredients to become one of India’s most admired digital economy clusters: a strong talent pipeline, high-quality of life, visionary leadership, and accelerating investor confidence.

But it will take collaborative intent, strategic execution, and continuous innovation to bring this vision to life.

The Draft Mangaluru Cluster Vision is not just a document—it is a commitment to shaping a new growth story—one where heritage meets innovation, culture enables commerce, and every citizen has a role to play in building a future-ready, inclusive digital economy.

Let’s #siliconbeacheofINDIA.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to all the stakeholders who played a pivotal role in shaping the Draft Vision Document for the Mangaluru Cluster. Your insights, expertise, and unwavering commitment have been instrumental in bringing this strategic vision to life.

Government of Karnataka – IT/BT Department:

We sincerely thank the senior leadership and officials of the Department of Electronics, IT, BT, and S&T, Government of Karnataka, whose strategic guidance and policy alignment laid a strong foundation for this vision. Your continued emphasis on regional innovation and inclusive growth has empowered this initiative.

Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM)

We acknowledge the visionary leadership of KDEM and the dedication of its functional teams across verticals—Startups, GCC, ESDM, Talent Accelerator, and Beyond Bengaluru. Their cross-sectoral expertise, grassroots coordination, and programmatic support have been central to anchoring this document in action-oriented realism.

Silicon Beach Program

We express our deep appreciation to the Silicon Beach Program for driving the narrative of Coastal Karnataka as a global technology destination. The program's focus on sustainable development, digital infrastructure, and diaspora-led innovation has been critical in influencing the thematic direction of this vision. Its emphasis on transforming the region from an education hub into a tech powerhouse has significantly strengthened the region's strategic positioning.

Mangaluru Cluster Industry Leaders

A special appreciation goes to our industry champions and anchor companies from Mangaluru, whose real-world insights, feedback on policy, and long-term thinking have significantly enriched this document. Your partnership strengthens the region's competitiveness and future-readiness.

Academia and Research Institutions

We are grateful to the universities, engineering colleges, and skill training partners who supported the development of talent-focused initiatives and innovation strategies featured in this vision.

Mangaluru Ecosystem Partners

We acknowledge the active role played by local chambers of commerce, incubators, accelerators, and industry associations—including TiE Mangaluru. Your collaboration has ensured that the vision is rooted in the aspirations and realities of Mangaluru's dynamic business ecosystem.

Feedback Advisory & Drafting Team

Our sincere thanks to the Feedback Advisory Team, who provided strategic inputs and helped structure the vision document in a coherent, impactful, and stakeholder-friendly format. Your facilitation helped shape our ideas into a concrete, actionable narrative.

Other Supporting Departments and Stakeholders

We also appreciate the contribution of KITS, District Administration Mangaluru, Infrastructure Development Department, Skill Development Department, and partner consultants whose coordination enabled the collation of critical data, policy inputs, and implementation models.

A Collective Commitment

This draft vision document is a testament to the collective efforts of all these stakeholders. It reflects our shared ambition to make Mangaluru, a thriving hub of innovation, investment, and inclusive economic growth.

We look forward to your continued collaboration in realizing this vision and in writing the next chapter of Karnataka's digital economy journey—**the Silicon Beach way**.

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Karnataka Digital
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Government of Karnataka

K-tech



STARTUP
KARNATAKA

BEYOND
BANGALORE